pollen from a plant is unable to germinate on its own stigma and will not be able to bring about fertilization in the ovules of the same plant. **East (1925)** observed multiple alleles in ***Nicotiana*** which are responsible for self-incompatibility or self-sterility. The gene for self-incompatibility can be designated as S, which has allelic series S_1, S_2, S_3, S_4 and S_5 (Figure 3.17).

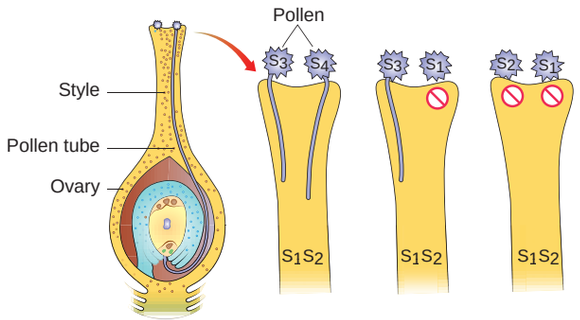


Figure: 3.17 The self-incompatibility in relation to its genotype in tobacco

The cross-fertilizing tobacco plants were not always homozygous as S_1S_1 or S_2S_2, but all plants were heterozygous as S_1S_2, S_3S_4, S_5S_6. When crosses were made between different S_1S_2 plants, the pollen tube did not develop normally. But effective pollen tube development was observed when crossing was made with other than S_1S_2 for example S_3S_4.

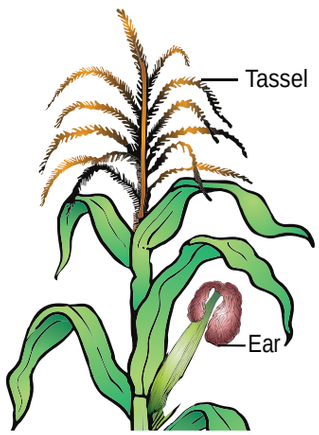
Female parent (Stigma spot)	**Male parent (Pollen source)**		
	S_1S_2	S_2S_3	S_3S_4
S_1S_2	Self Sterile	S_3S_2 S_3S_1	S_3S_1 S_3S_2 S_4S_1 S_4S_2
S_2S_3	S_1S_2 S_1S_3	Self Sterile	S_4S_2 S_4S_3
S_3S_4	S_1S_3 S_1S_4 S_2S_3 S_2S_4	S_2S_3 S_2S_4	Self Sterile

Table: 3.5. Different combinations of progeny in self-incompatibility

When crosses were made between seed parents with S_1S_2 and pollen parents with S_2S_3, two kinds of pollen tubes were distinguished. Pollen grains carrying S_2 were not effective, but the pollen grains carrying S_3 were capable of fertilization. Thus, from the cross $S_1S_2XS_3S_4$, all the pollens were effective and four kinds of progeny resulted: S_1S_3, S_1S_4, S_2S_3 and S_2S_4. Some combinations are showed in the table-3.5.

3.5.3 Sex determination in maize

Zea mays (maize) is an example for monoecious, which means male and female flowers are present on the same plant. There are two types of inflorescence. The terminal inflorescence which bears staminate florets develops from shoot apical meristem called **tassel.** The lateral inflorescence which develop pistillate florets from axillary bud is called **ear or cob.** Unisexuality in maize occurs through the selective abortion of stamens in ear florets and pistils in tassel florets. A substitution of two single gene pairs '**ba**' for barren plant and '**ts**' for tassel seed makes the difference between monoecious and dioecious (rare) maize plants. The allele for barren plant (ba) when homozygous makes the stalk staminate by eliminating silk and ears. The allele for tassel seed (ts) transforms tassel into a pistillate structure that produce no pollen. The table-3.7 is the resultant sex expression based on the combination of these alleles. Most of these mutations are shown to be defects in gibberellin biosynthesis. Gibberellins play an important role in the suppression of stamens in florets on the ears.



Inflorescence of *Zea mays*

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